



Figure 9: Share access control

Groups and users

Next, we create groups and users. The LDAP service must be active to do this. From the *Accounts* tab, select the *Authentication* menu. Fill in the LDAP settings (Figure 6), and tick the *Use Local LDAP Server* check-box. Submit the configuration information, wait for about a minute, and under the *Services* tab, verify that the LDAP service is enabled.

Instead of LDAP, you can configure authentication with a Windows domain controller from this page. *Administrator* credentials are required to enable access control based on pre-configured groups and user-names. LDAP service configuration may give a few surprises, which will result in failure to create groups and users. Try the following if you are facing problems at this juncture:

1. Clear and rebuild the LDAP server from the *Services > Set-up* menu.
2. Make sure that you have updated Openfiler fully using *conary updateall* as discussed earlier. If not, do so now. (Community forums report that there was a bug in the original distro, which was fixed by updates.) While preparing screen-shots for this article, I had taken a short-cut of not updating the distro. Ultimately, LDAP failed, and I had to complete updates before proceeding (Figure 7).

Create a new group, overriding the GID. Here, a GID range starting from 501 is used for the *SongLovers* group. Additional groups can be created as and when required, for granular access control. Go on creating user accounts with their passwords, and assign them their primary group (Figure 8).



Note: To change groups and user settings, use the *Group/User* administration tabs.

Quota allocation and shares

After creating groups and users, the next task is to allocate quotas. Here, for the *SongLovers* group, we assigned a 20 GB quota. User-wise quota definition is also possible.

We also created the shares: *Firstvolume > songs > marathi* and *Firstvolume > songs > hindi*.

A new share is accessible only after granting specific access. Click the share name and configure the three required parameters (Table 3).

Table 3: Share Parameters

Share access control mode	Public guest access or Controlled access
Group access configuration	Primary group and type of access—No access/Read only (RO)/Read-Write (RW)
Host access configuration	Type of access to be granted (from 5 possible services: SMB/CIFS, NFS, HTTPS, FTP and RSYNC). Select all which you want, and set the share's type of access (No/RO or RW).

Here, we defined the '*Marathi*' share with *Controlled* access, giving the primary group '*SongLovers*' RW access. Further, we enabled RW access via SMB/CIFS and FTP protocols (Figure 9). (Remember to use the *Services* menu to enable the FTP service if using FTP shares!)

That is all, folks!! Start browsing the shared resources by the IP address. You should see your shares—in our case, *firstvolume.songs.marathi*—as a shared folder. Enter your user credentials, and start using your NAS!

In future articles, we will continue to discuss various interesting features of Openfiler. 

References

- Installation screen-shots are available at <http://www.openfiler.com/products/screenshots>.
 - Openfiler has a great community. The forum can be accessed at <http://openfiler.com/community/forums>.
 - Download page: <http://openfiler.com/community/download/>.
 - The Openfiler administration guide is available for 40 Euros from <http://www.openfiler.com/docs/manual/>.
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